

World History





About the Course

One of the most powerful truths that history can teach us is that the past was different from the present. The way things are now is not the way they have always been, which should make us aware of the likelihood that the way things are now is not how they will be. The study of world history exposes students to what life was like in different places and at different times. As students read about people and events from 1800-1900 through history spines, historical novels, and primary source documents, they will get a better picture of the way people viewed the world, the challenges they faced, and the legacy they left behind. Students will also view images, reference maps, and work on their Book of Centuries as part of their lessons.

This topic is included in the following course(s): History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.), History: Grades 7-8 (Canada)



Placement & Combining Tips

Suitable for Grade 9. However, Grade 9 does include a term of lessons on historical thinking skills, which should not be skipped. So if combining 9th graders in this course, be sure to have them read that book next year.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
7-8	World History: Grades 7-8 1 time/week 30 min	Eiffel's Tower for Young People In the Shadow of the Alamo

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)				
	World History: Grades 7-8 U.S. History: Grades 7-8		Ancient History: Grades 7-9 U.S. History: Grades 7-8	
History: Grades 7-8 (Canada)				
	World History: Grades 7-8 Canadian History: Grades 7-8		Ancient History: Grades 7-9 Canadian History: Grades 7-8	



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

World History: Grades 7-8



Eiffel's Tower for Young People



In the Shadow of the Alamo



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

(No Quick Links Assigned)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



World History: Grades 7-8

How To Teach



Prepare

- Read through the lesson and gather any necessary links.
- If you have not read the book, you may want to read the selected pages in advance.
- Decide which lessons/books to read together and which to have students read independently.



Recap

- Connect back to the previous lesson. Have students give a summary of what they remember. (Full narration is not necessary.)
- If the previous passage is difficult to remember, teachers may ask a leading question: "What can you tell me about..." Or students may try looking back at any chapter/section headings or illustrations or reading the first paragraph to jog the memory.



Introduce

- Use a picture, map, or engaging question to pique the student's interest in the day's lesson (often included in lesson plans).
- If necessary, talk about a few unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding.



Read

- Read the day's passage out loud or have the student read independently. Sometimes reading for the specified time is a better guide.
- If a book is challenging, try stopping to narrate every now and then rather than waiting until the end. It can also help to read aloud. Or you might want to use an audiobook version of the text and have students read along with it.
- Have students keep an eye out for events or characters to add to their Citizenship Notebook, Book of Centuries, or Copywork Book.



Narrate

- Have students retell the passage orally or write a narration.
- Alternatively, students might analyze a character, trace cause to consequence, outline a passage, or use one of the other methods indicated by Charlotte Mason in School Education Chapter 16, especially p.180.
- Students who enjoy writing can experiment with different types of written narrations, but this is not required.



Discuss

- Give the student an opportunity to share thoughts on the lesson and any connections made (orally or in writing).

- You could ask them what they thought about the passage or ask an open-ended question to stimulate discussion. Discussion questions are often included in the lesson plans.



Connect

- Optional: Add something to the Book of Centuries, Century Chart, Citizenship Notebook, or Commonplace book. If students would like to include pictures, these may be drawn or printed.

World History: Grades 7-8

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Term 1

WEEK 1 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 1

Los Soldados, A Terrible Mistake

Materials: In the Shadow of the Alamo

→ INTRO

This is a historical fiction book that takes place in 1835-1836. This genre of book allows you to walk in the shoes of the soldiers of Mexico who were forced to fight the Americans at the Battle of the Alamo. As you read, you will see Spanish terms in italics. You can find the meaning of those words at the back of the book.

→ LOCATE

∞ Map Link: Mexico

Find Guanajuato, which is located in central Mexico, about 130 miles northwest of Mexico City. How would you describe the terrain of this area?

Lorenzo lives in this village.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.1-14 "If someone sat" - "frown on her face."

- How would you describe Lorenzo so far?

→ VIEW

The predominant religion of Mexico is Roman Catholicism. Our Lady of Guadalupe holds a special place in the religious life of Mexico and is one of the most popular religious devotions. Her image, a woman of mixed Indigenous and European features wearing a turquoise-colored mantle surrounded by a sunburst, has played an important role as a national symbol of Mexico.

∞ Image Link: Virgin of Guadalupe

• DEFINITIONS

conscrip: (p.6) enrolled into service by compulsion : drafted

dragoon: (p.7) mounted soldiers that fought both on horseback and on foot

WEEK 2 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 2

A Terrible Mistake, Following the Eagle

Materials: In the Shadow of the Alamo

→RECAP

What is happening so far in the book?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.14-28 "We did not" - "Something peaceful."

- What do you think about the idea of allowing a man's family to travel with him in war?
- How would you prove your age? Why was it hard for Lorenzo to prove he was only fifteen?

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Picture of General Antonio López de Santa Anna

WEEK 3 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 3

Following the Eagle, The Deserters

Materials: In the Shadow of the Alamo

→RECAP

Tell briefly what you read.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview the crude comment on p.34 made by Bernardo.

World History: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

p.28-42 "I have played" - "happen, again, sir."

- What were some reasons men would desert the army?

WEEK 4 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 4

The Deserters, A Thing of the Past

Materials: In the Shadow of the Alamo

→RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.42-59 "Lieutenant Ochoa shouted" - "that haughty Esteban?"

- Why do you think the punishments were so severe for deserters?

WEEK 5 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 5

El Presidio

Materials: In the Shadow of the Alamo

→RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ LOCATE

∞ Map Link: Map of Mexico

Find San Luis Potosí. How would you describe the terrain of this area?
Lorenzo visits this village with his fellow conscripts.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.60-75 "On the fourth" - "soldiers shut up."

- How did Lorenzo feel at the idea of visiting another village outside of his own?

• DEFINITIONS

peons: (p.60) person of low social status or a laborer with no skills

★ TEACHER NOTE

There is a description of a woman's body on p.62 that you might want to preview.

WEEK 6 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 6

El Presidio, El Presidente

Materials: In the Shadow of the Alamo

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.75-90 "Return to your" - "to be there."

- How does Lorenzo view education? How does El Presidente view music? What do their views tell you about what's important to Lorenzo and El Presidente?

★ TEACHER NOTE

There is an implication on p.89 that you might want to preview.

WEEK 7 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 7

El Presidente, The Importance of Goats

Materials: In the Shadow of the Alamo

→ INTRO

Lorenzo and Estaban find themselves in a tricky situation. As you read through this section, think about how many people went through similar situations to Lorenzo. What would you do if you were accused of something and no one was listening to you?

World History: Grades 7-8

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Term 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.90-103 "Esteban and I" - "wanted to hear."

- Why does Lorenzo change his mind about the importance of goats?

WEEK 8 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 8

A Rumor of War, Feliz Navidad

Materials: In the Shadow of the Alamo

→RECAP

Tell briefly what you read.

→ LOCATE

∞ Map Link: Mexico

Find Saltillo and Coahuila on the map.

Lorenzo and the rest of the army pack up to head to these towns.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.104-120 "I was an" - "this pace last?"

- What celebrations do Lorenzo and the rest of the army join in? Discuss what these celebrations look like. How does everyone react to news about the war?

★ TEACHER NOTE

There is a situation that you might want to preview on p.109.

WEEK 9 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 9

Feliz Navidad, The General's Orders, La Llorona

Materials: In the Shadow of the Alamo

→ INTRO

Three Kings Day, or Epiphany, as it is called, celebrates the day the three wise men encountered the Baby Jesus and brought him gifts. It's also the day that many kids get their presents. Epiphany, or Three Kings Day, is celebrated all over the world, and its traditions differ from people group to people group.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.120-135 "On Christmas Eve" - "in their hands."

- How do Lorenzo's Christmas traditions differ from your own? Are you familiar with any of his traditions?

WEEK 10 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 10

La Llorona, White Death

Materials: In the Shadow of the Alamo

→RECAP

Tell briefly what you read.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.135-150 "For over a" - "step for step."

- La Llorona is an urban legend in Lorenzo's culture. What are some urban legends you are familiar with?

World History: Grades 7-8

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Term 1

WEEK 11 📅 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 11

White Death, Tejas

📄 Materials: In the Shadow of the Alamo

→ RECAP

Tell briefly what you read.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.150-166 "By February 13" - "sage-covered plain."

- How does Lorenzo deal with the loss of his family members?

★ TEACHER NOTE

There is a situation that you might want to preview on p.160.

WEEK 12 📅 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 12

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
In the Shadow of the Alamo

World History: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 1 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 13

Tejas, San Antonio de Bèxar

Materials: In the Shadow of the Alamo

→RECAP

Tell briefly what you read.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.166-180 "We marched along" - "help us all."

- What is surprising about this part of Lorenzo's journey?

WEEK 2 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 14

Dawn at the Alamo

Materials: In the Shadow of the Alamo

→ NOTE

Due to the graphic description of the aftermath of the war, we are skipping several sections. Please note the page numbers that are listed.

→RECAP

Tell briefly what you read.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Ch.16 p.181-190
2. selection of Ch.17 p.197-200 "In what seemed" - "this behind you."
3. selection of Ch.17 p.203-207 "I began searching" - end.

- What surprised you in the reading?

WEEK 3 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 15

A Small Affair, A Quiet Death

Materials: In the Shadow of the Alamo

→RECAP

Tell briefly what you read.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Skip the beginning of Ch.18 and begin at p.214-229 "Suddenly I saw" - end

- What could have been different if General Santa Anna had waited for reinforcements?

WEEK 4 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 16

The Advance

Materials: In the Shadow of the Alamo

→RECAP

Tell briefly what you read.

→ LOCATE

∞ Map Link: Mexico

Find San Antonio.

Lorenzo says, "As we marched past the ruins of the Alamo, my heart ached. Here we had fought a vain and pointless battle and lost the flower of our army for no cause other than the egotism of His Excellency." Lorenzo and the rest of his unit would have fought in what is now San Antonio, Texas.

★ TEACHER NOTE

Due to sensitive content, students will skip from p.242-252.



Term 2

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.20 p.230-242 "Our division pulled" - "on its prow."

Ch.21 p.252-262 "As we plodded" - "men were doomed."

WEEK 5 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 17

Toward Destiny, San Jacinto

Materials: In the Shadow of the Alamo

→RECAP

Tell briefly what you read.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.262-280 "That night the" - end of book

- Why did Lorenzo make the choice he made at the beginning of the chapter?

WEEK 6 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 18

Showdown in Paris

Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People, notebook

→ INTRO

When you think of Paris, France, what image comes to mind? For most people, it is the Eiffel Tower. But did you know that many people were against the building of the Eiffel Tower, and many obstacles almost prevented the Eiffel Tower from being built? This book will tell that story. It also tells the story about what life was like at the end of the 19th century and introduces us to people from around the world.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Ch.1 p.1-12 (Read the narrative and skip blue pages.) Beginning - "too-tight corset."

2. Blue pages p.14-16 (Optional p.4-5)

- Why do you think it was important for the French to build something taller than the Americans?

→ VIEW

This 555-foot stone pillar was the tallest human-made structure at the time.

∞ Image Link: Washington Monument

→ NOTEBOOK

Each chapter features recurring characters who were connected in some way to the 1889 World's Fair. Create a graphic organizer or a list that will help you keep track of the individuals that you will encounter in this text. You may want to put only one or two people on a page so you have room to add details. You will add to these pages when you encounter the character again in a subsequent chapter. A list of the people mentioned in this book is listed on p. ix-xi. It might be helpful to look back at it as you read. Begin your list of characters: Gustave Eiffel, Annie Oakley, William F. Cody (Buffalo Bill), Thomas Edison.

This is an example of a graphic organizer that creates a timeline for the character. You can also just list descriptions about them in a column.

∞ Image Link: Example of graphic organizer

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview the incident mentioned at the top of p.11 that talks about James Bennett's drunken behavior.

• DEFINITIONS

uncouth: behaving in a rude way
: not polite or socially acceptable



Term 2

WEEK 7 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 19

Showdown in Paris, Eiffel Under Attack

Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People, notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. p.13-29 "Many Americans were" - "French Catholic parents."
2. (Optional) Blue pages on p.30-32

- Why do you think world fairs were such an important event, especially in that time period?
- Why do you think America and France seemed to be in competition with each other?

→ VIEW

You can view a few of the paintings of James McNeill Whistler, the American painter based in England, known for post-impressionism.

∞ Link: Paintings of James McNeill Whistler

→ NOTEBOOK

Add more names to your character list: James McNeill Whistler, Van Gogh Brothers, Paul Gauguin.

WEEK 8 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 20

Eiffel Under Attack

Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People, notebook

→RECAP

What happened last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. p.33-49 "On June 12" - "to complete it."
2. (Optional) Blue pages p.50-51

- Why do you think Gustave Eiffel was so determined to build the tower, even if he had to use his own money?
- Why do you think so many people were against the building of the tower?

→ NOTEBOOK

Add information to your character list for Gustave Eiffel.

WEEK 9 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 21

Troubles on the Tower

Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People, notebook

→RECAP

Where are we in the story?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. p.55-73
2. (Optional) Blue pages p.62-63

→ VIEW

∞ Link: Gauguin painting

Look at this painting from when Gauguin was in Arles and read the paragraph explaining it.

World History: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

→ NOTEBOOK

Add information to your character list: Gustave Eiffel, James McNeill Whistler, Van Gogh brothers, Paul Gauguin, Buffalo Bill, Annie Oakley.

WEEK 10 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 22

Going Up!

Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People, notebook

→RECAP

Briefly summarize the previous reading.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.75-89 "February 4, 1899" - "the cars themselves."

→ NOTEBOOK

Make a sketch of the Eiffel Tower. You can use pictures in the book or the link given.

∞ Image Link: Eiffel Tower

WEEK 11 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 23

Going Up! (cont.)

Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People, notebook

→RECAP

What was the last reading about?

→ INTRO

Do you have anything in your home that has an Eiffel Tower on it or a small model of one? Eiffel Tower mania became a thing back in 1889!

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

- p.89-108 "As the months" - "of American tourists."
- (Optional) Blue pages on p.90-91, 100-101

- Why do you think the people who criticized the tower came to appreciate it?
- What do you think was the most challenging part about building the tower?

→ NOTEBOOK

Add information to your character list for Gustave Eiffel and Annie Oakley.

WEEK 12 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Eiffel's Tower for Young People

World History: Grades 7-8

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Term 3

WEEK 1 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 25

Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People, notebook

→RECAP

Where are we at in the story?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.111-124 "On Sunday, March 31" - "to Theo's wife."

→ NOTEBOOK

Add information to your character list for Gustave Eiffel, James McNeill Whistler, Van Gogh brothers, Paul Gauguin.

• IMPORTANT DATES

1889 Eiffel Tower is completed

WEEK 2 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 26

Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People, notebook

→RECAP

What happened last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

- p.124-145 "In his laboratory" - "dramas, and amusements."
- (Optional) Blue pages on p.132-133

→ NOTEBOOK

Add information to your character list for Thomas Edison, Buffalo Bill, Annie Oakley.

• IMPORTANT DATES

1889 Opening of Universal Exposition

• EXTRA HELPING

This video explains how the phonogram works.

∞ Video Link: Edison's Phonograph

WEEK 3 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 27

Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People, notebook

→RECAP

Summarize the previous reading.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.147-163 "In the first" - "her husband's death."

- Why do you think the people were interested in the Wild West Shows?
- How did the Wild West Show both represent and misrepresent the United States in 1889?

→ NOTEBOOK

Add information to your character list for Buffalo Bill, Annie Oakley, Gustave Eiffel.

WEEK 4 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 28

Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People, notebook

→ NOTE

For the sake of time, we are skipping a few pages that talk about some issues with the elevators.

→RECAP

Briefly recap the last reading.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

- p.171-188 "Monday, June 10" - "dollar to invest."
- (Optional) Blue pages p.182-183

- What section would you be most interested in visiting?

World History: Grades 7-8

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Term 3

- Why do you think people weren't impressed with the American exhibits?

→ NOTEBOOK

Add information to your character list for Thomas Edison.

WEEK 5 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 29

Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People, notebook

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. p.188-209 "Annie Oakley" - "AAA's bids."
2. (Optional) Blue pages p.196-197

→ NOTEBOOK

Add information to your character list for Annie Oakley, Buffalo Bill.

→ VIEW

1. Here is an image of the painting that was up for auction at the exposition.

∞ Image Link: Angelus by Millet

2. Read about the painting on p.206-207.

WEEK 6 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 30

Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People, notebook

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.209-228 "At about one" - "bed at daylight."

- How did the Fourth of July bring more friendship than competition between France and the U.S.?

→ VIEW

Whistler had received a gold medal for his painting.

∞ Image Link: Painting of Lady Archibald Campbell

→ NOTEBOOK

Add information to your character list for James McNeill Whistler.

WEEK 7 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 31

Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People, notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.228-249 "Right after the" - "the Persian King."

→ NOTEBOOK

Add information to your character list for Buffalo Bill and Annie Oakley.

World History: Grades 7-8

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Term 3

WEEK 8 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 32

Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People, notebook

→RECAP

Summarize the previous reading.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. p.253-274 "The United States" - "entertain the crowd." (Skip p.249-253)
2. (Optional) Blue pages p.270-271

→ NOTEBOOK

Add information to your character list for Thomas Edison.

WEEK 9 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 33

Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People, notebook

→RECAP

What happened last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. p.275-285 "Thomas Edison had" - "La Champagne."
2. Skip p.287-297 (for the sake of time)
3. p.297-305 "The steamship La Champagne" - "events in history."
4. (Optional) Blue pages p.278

→ VIEW

During the Exposition, an artist painted this picture showing Thomas Edison with the phonograph.

∞ Image Link: Painting of Thomas Alva Edison

→ NOTEBOOK

Add information to your character list for Thomas Edison and Gustave Eiffel.

WEEK 10 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 34

Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People, notebook

→RECAP

Summarize the previous reading.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. p.307-325 "The 1889 World's" - "change its mind."
2. (Optional) Blue pages p.316-318

→ NOTEBOOK

Add information to your character list for Gustave Eiffel, Van Gogh brothers, Gauguin, Whistler, Buffalo Bill.

★ TEACHER NOTE

Please preview the mention of suicide on p.310.

WEEK 11 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 35

Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People, notebook

→RECAP

What happened last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. p.326-346 "Back in Europe" - end of book (Feel free to skip p.340-344 "The Newspaper Man and the War.")

- What character in this book did you find most interesting? Why?

World History: Grades 7-8

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Term 3

2. (Optional) Blue page p.342 → NOTEBOOK Add information to your character list for Annie Oakley, Thomas Edison, Gustave Eiffel.	
WEEK 12  30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 36 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Eiffel's Tower for Young People	

World History: Grades 7-8

Examination

- Term 1** · In the Shadow of the Alamo: What is a part of Lorenzo and Esteban's story that stood out to you?
- Term 2** · Eiffel's Tower: Tell the story of the planning and construction of the Eiffel Tower and explain why it was significant.
- Term 3** · Eiffel's Tower: How did the Eiffel Tower and the 1889 World's Fair demonstrate the spirit of innovation, progress, and change in the late nineteenth century? OR Pick one of the characters you read about and tell their story and how they represent that period of time.